

WED., APRIL 24, 1957 THE MINNEAPOLIS STAR

## CHARLES JOHNSON'S Lowdown on Sports

★ THE MINNEAPOLIS MILLERS return to Metropolitan stadium Thursday for the first league home game of the 1957 season with the big question about the team's strength centering around the hitters.

The club's pitching staff at the moment isn't deep enough to carry an unimpaired season, but the local payroll for some time.

The hitting problem became acute in the three losses to Charleston over the past week-end, but Orlando Cepeda picked the Louisville series to come out of his slump with a vengeance.

One man can make a big difference in a club's offense. Cepeda had hit so well in spring training that Manager Red Davis figured he would be able to carry on in triple A company despite a long jump from the lower minors.

However, his poor start when the regular season opened created considerable worry. Now the newscaster apparently is out of it.

HE COULD HOLD the key to the Miller's success at home. Every one knows Carlos Paula will hit. If Hank Thompson can regain his batting eye once he returns to the lineup any likelihood Davis may have should disappear. Jim Davenport's good start augurs well for him at the plate.

The Miller broke even on their first road swing, but they have done it at the expense of what could be the weaker half of the league. Indianapolis and Louisville aren't too impressive at the moment and three of the Miller's first four wins have come at their expense.

General Manager Roy Ryan knows his club has to have some additional strength to be a serious contender, but he thinks between the Giants and other connections he has to get the help needed.

The Miller can come with local enthusiasm running even higher than a year ago now that the fans have been thoroughly acclimated to their new playing facilities.

Let the club get its share of wins and it will not lack for patronage.

## Flanagan's Toughest Foe

★ IN ANALYZING the recent victories of Del Flanagan that skyrocketed him into such a big office attraction in St. Paul, it's a fair statement that he has had fairly easy competition.

Del has licked Jim Heggie, Joe Schmolze and Ramon Fuentes. He did it so impressively each time that gate receipts jumped perceptibly.

As railbirds look back on this successful comeback, they agree that Heggie furnished the stiffest opposition. Fuentes was a terrific disappointment. Schmolze collapsed with a broken leg.

It may be a different story tonight when Flanagan faces Kid Gavilan. The bout has stirred up so much interest among ticket buyers that a new money record for the state is possible.

Gavilan, by reputation at least, is the biggest name Del has faced. Whether he's as tough as his reputation indicates is something else again.

The Cuban certainly isn't the fighter he once was when he ruled the welterweight ranks. How far he has slipped, if any, is a question that will be answered until he struts his stuff in the ring tonight.

Gavilan appears reasonably fit now for a man of 31. Whether his punch has lost any of its zip remains to be seen. There is the question, too, of how long he will hold up physically if Flanagan sets a blistering pace.

In his recent appearances, Flanagan has appeared unbeatable. He has been in the best shape of his career. He seems to be concentrating more on his work than ever before.

Because he is a home town favorite, the St. Paul boy has been established as a likely winner. Whether the advance dope is correct will be determined about the fifth, sixth or seventh rounds of the scrap.

This match is something of a turning point for Gavilan, too. While he has some attractive bouts lined up for himself in the immediate future, a defeat at the hands of Flanagan will not help him any in keeping busy. Flanagan rates well as a fighter only in these parts at the moment because of his erratic career.

Tonight is no time for either Del or the Kid to throw a mauling wrench in the short fiscal prosperity era that Promoter Jack Ralston is enjoying down the river. That can be avoided if both main events give their best.

## Boxing for Every One

★ COMPETITIVE BOXING for every one is getting quite a lift from Shane McCarthy, national head of President Eisenhower's physical fitness program that is being revived in a big way.

Johnny Walsh, Wisconsin boxing coach, reported to the Old Guards Monday night that McCarthy is advocating boxing for all boys from grade school through colleges as the best way to get the job done.

"McCarthy thinks that there is no sport that can raise the physical standards of our youth faster than boxing," Walsh asserts. "That should be good news to all of us who have fought so hard to keep this clean, amateur activity alive."

What's more the youngsters are eager to learn how to defend themselves. Just a little encouragement from adults and good instruction will do the job in a hurry.

## Flanagan Puts His Future on Line Against Gavilan

By BILL HINGEN  
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

Del Flanagan and Kid Gavilan turn back boxing's clock tonight in the St. Paul auditorium. Their 10 round welterweight fight may set an all-time figure for Minnesota at the gate.

Interest in the match between the two "old pros" has spread like a grass fire since Gavilan arrived in the Twin Cities 10 days ago. So the high money mark—\$41,863.15 established in 1915 when Mike O'Dowd met Mike Gibbons may be surpassed.

THE ST. PAUL 145-pounder goes into tonight's bout as the favorite but with the time, enjoys fighting in possibility of ending up in a sports. He may coast for half "virtual" fight for his life, as the crowd, then turn out as far as the future goes.

# After 8 Years Burnside Makes 'Big Time'

From the Star Sports Wire  
Pete Burnside, a tall, handsome fast-baller, today became a first-line pitcher on the New York Giants' staff after eight years of trying.

Still a rookie at 26, Burnside has been in the New York organization eight years, but his masterful three-hit, 14 shutout of the Pittsburgh Pirates Tuesday was only his third major league start.

The Giants called him up from the Minneapolis Millers at the tail-end of the '55 season and three same buccos knocked him out of the box in his first start.

"WHAT A pickup he gave us," proclaimed Giant Manager Bill Rigney, who was rapidly running out of pitchers. In fact, the only reason Burnside got the call yesterday was because Al Worthington and Curt Barry have not lived up to expectations.

"I can hardly wait to see him again," continued Rigney, indicating that he would start Rigney again as soon as he has had a few days' rest.

When the Giants first assembled at spring training, Rigney said he hoped Burnside would develop into a starter. But Pete was wild. Until he tamed the Bucs, he hadn't pitched since April 10 in Miami.

"I relied mostly on fast balls," he smiled, "especially in the late innings."

"His fast ball really was alive," commented catcher Wally Westrum, "but the thing that impressed me the most was that he mixed them up and was getting everything over."

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Minneapolis was finally stopped 3-2 in 10 innings on Cal Neenan's home run and Cincinnati nipped the Cardinals 6-4.

MEANWHILE, National league commissioner Warren Giles has stated that he and his umpires do not believe that Milwaukee pitcher Lew Burdette is guilty of throwing a spitball.

Burdette immediately demanded an apology from Cincinnati manager Birdie Tebbets, his No. 1 reliever. Tebbets replied, "I have nothing to say."

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# Miller to Face Tribe in Home Debut

SIX NEW MILLER FACES YOU'LL SEE HERE THURSDAY

4-4 Split Marks First Road Trip

By BOB BEERE  
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

CHICAGO, Ill.—The Minneapolis Miller were en route home today to open the home season at Metropolitan Stadium Thursday at 2:30 p.m., bringing a 4-4 record for the first road trip after defeating Louisville 4-3 Tuesday night.

Manager Red Davis was reasonably satisfied with the even break and was not inclined to worry even with three of his best men sidelined by injuries to cut into the manpower of an already short-handed roster.

In fact, Red was not awed by anything his Millers have met so far and has gone ahead to set up a pitching rotation which he plans to stick with as far as possible.

STU MILLER will face Indianapolis tomorrow as the welterweight of the flock. Davis plans to pitch him every fourth day even if one of his other starters has to miss a turn or be set back.

Al Corwin, Vibert Clarke and Mike Blyskal will follow in that order with the other three also-bodded hurlers Freddy Rodriguez, Roger Bowman and Joe Shipley handling the relief chores.

Red admits the staff is a bit thin with Jim Constance probably out for at least two more weeks with his fractured right wrist and the New York Giants holding tight to a dozen pitchers, but he is optimistic.

"So far our pitching has been very good. Each of the starters has pitched at least one, and some of them two, good games," he pointed out. "If the staff can continue to do as well as it has we'll be all right. When the Giants finally do spring, the right guys could make our pitching really tough."

AS FOR the opposition faced so far Red says, "I think we are at least as good as anything we've seen. I'd rate Wichita the best of the four mainly because of its pitching. I think we'll be able to handle their left-handed hitters okay when our southpaws get straightened around."

"We could have won three or four more games on the trip with a little more punch and I'm willing to at least go along with (Orlando) Cepeda at first base for a while longer."

"Sure we could use some left-handed hitting. I've been saying that since March. Henry Thompson could provide some of it when his shoulder breaks up and one more wouldn't hurt."

Thompson also is feeling better and might play the home opener but no chances will be taken with his ailing left arm.

The Miller had a big scare in the ninth inning last night before Rodriguez finally got the side out.

Blyskal had run his string of scoreless innings to 17 when the Colonels broke through in the ninth, although Don Gray had to make a great throw to the plate to cut off a run in the first inning.

John J. Wukitch, Art Duhan doubled him to third and when Blyskal passed Rocky Tedesco to fill the bases, Clarke was called upon to pitch to pinch hitter Jack Parks.

Colonel Manager D. C. Mauer and Vibert walked Blyskal to force in June. Rod, too, along with Ryan, Davis, Rogers came in to fan Dave and the entire Miller squad, which will be introduced by a stage made it 4-3 before Tony which was introduced by Baltimore popped out.

ANDY COHEN will make a Meyer then substituted Ray special trip over from St. Paul to be an honored guest later, too, along with Ryan, Davis, Rogers came in to fan Dave and the entire Miller squad, which will be introduced by a stage made it 4-3 before Tony which was introduced by Baltimore popped out.

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# Stadium Anniversary

IT'S ALL NEW; COHEN HONORED

By HALSEY HALL  
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

Metropolitan stadium celebrates its first anniversary Thursday.

One year ago the Minneapolis Miller opened on Bloomington's blooming greenwood and the dawn of a new era saw Charley Gorn and Willie Stark's band.

Now, with building dreams come true, the clock of 2:30 p.m. Thursday will be almost more newness than was on view in 1956. A new manager, over a dozen new faces and a "new" return of one of Minneapolis' all-time favorites in the person of Andy Cohen, will be followed by the presentation to Cohen, after which the bakers will come.

THE P.R.E-GAME does not start at 2:30 when the Marine color guard hoists Metropolitan's flag to its first spring breeze of a new campaign.

This will be followed by the presentation to Cohen, after which the bakers will come.

ROGERS GETS EDGE IN TV

PROVIDENCE, R. I. (UP)—Harold Gornes, New England featherweight champion from Providence, meets Bobby Rogers of Chicago tonight in this city's first nationally televised fight, (CN 11).

Rogers, who has won 10 times and fought two draws in 14 professional starts, is a slight choice although he has had far less experience than Gornes.

He will take part in the pregame ceremonies, which will be brief, and what's more, he will be one of the honored personalities present for Ryan and the Minneapolis ball club will give him something to remember the old days.

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